

Committee:	Commission on Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice
Agenda item:	Discussing the efficiency and ethical implications of maximum security prisons
Main Submitter:	<i>Republic of El Salvador</i>
Co-submitters:	<i>Romania, United States of America, Japan</i>
Signatories:	Republic of the Philippines, United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, Republic of Kenya, Argentine Republic, United Mexican States, Federative Republic of Brazil, Canada, Republic of Colombia, Arab Republic of Egypt, Federal Republic of Germany , French Republic, Republic of India, Kingdom of Norway, Republic of South Africa, Swiss Confederation, Republic of Indonesia, Italian Republic

Guided by the principal purposes of the United Nations, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, and The United Nations Standard Minimum Rules for the Treatment of Prisoners in order to reaffirm faith in fundamental human rights, in the dignity and worth of the human person, without distinction of any kind, and in the equal rights of men and women and of nations large and small,

Fully believing in compliance with both high-security conditions and human right standards,

Acknowledges the violation of human rights and supports the implementation of further measures,

Noting that many countries are still developing and are lacking money to spare money in order to enhance their high-security prisons,

Deeply concerned about the high operational cost and high recidivism in maximum security prisons,

Recognizing the importance of ensuring the physical and mental wellbeing of inmates through the help of rehabilitation programs,

Convinced by the fact that if we combine our resources and get involved in this matter together we will achieve global security while still maintaining ethical standards,

Confident that all member states are keeping in check with the Nelson Mandela Rules and the Convention Against Torture,

Keeping in mind that the lack of rehabilitation and reinsertion leads to prisoners' recidivism,

Emphasizing the critical need for ethical education and transparent governance to uphold principled standards in maximum security prison systems,

Aware of the expenses of the countries spent on the high-security prisons are not sufficient enough to arrange their budget;

1. **Proposes** the creation of an international fund supported by the UN and its Member States, based on their ability to contribute, so that nations can benefit from it by renewing infrastructures or renovating existing ones, training staff, and offering new or improved methods to rehabilitate detainees, functioning by:
 - a. using the money which is lent by the IMF and the World Bank for the created fund,
 - b. giving the money to countries, on request,
 - c. deciding whether the money is needed or not for the country that requested the monetary resources by the commission of the international fund,
 - d. establishing a monitoring system which observes whether the member countries use the obtained money from the fund by:
 - i. revising monthly checks for their expenses on prisons,

- ii. tightening the decisive organ its commission, in case of any abuse with the usage of the money which was lent by the international fund;

2. **Calls for** the establishment of a new technology-sharing programme called Informative Communicative Manufacturing Initiative (ICMI), developed by the UN Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies (UNODET), with contributions from UN Trade and Development (UNCTAD) and the UN Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO), instituted for:
 - a. the improvement of prisons' data banking at the benefit of countries aligned activities,
 - b. a greater impact and effective coordination within globally agreed frameworks, such as:
 - i. the Pact for the Future,
 - ii. the Sustainable Development Goals,
 - iii. the World Summit on the Information Society;
3. **Proposes** that all Member States try to embrace a balance between solitary confinement and rehabilitation programs, particularly in maximum-security prisons by:
 - a. Ensuring that solitary confinement is applied only when necessary, being strictly regulated and limited, in accordance with the Nelson Mandela Rules,
 - b. accepting access to educational and vocational facilities;
4. **Recommends** professional trainings and courses for employed prison personnel, that shall be named “Maximum Security Prison Staff Training Programme”, alongside the help of UN organisations and experts, through the fund mentioned in OC number 1, aiming to:
 - a. Assure that the staff is properly informed of the human rights of inmates and the possible punishments they can receive by violating them,
 - b. Eradicate favoritism and special treatment towards prisoners, by creating a respectful environment in which the rules apply to everyone,

- c. Establish continuous psychological and ethical assessment programs, aimed at identifying potential abuse of authority, stress-related misconduct, and ensuring adherence to international human rights standards;
- 5. **Encourages** monthly unannounced check-ups done by UN officials in facilities participating in the training programs mentioned in OC number 4;
- 6. **Recommends** limiting the use of solitary confinement in accordance with international human rights standards, to be applied only in extreme circumstances, under strict regulations, that will work as follows:
 - a. Establishing a maximum duration not longer than 15 days,
 - b. Requiring mental and psychological evaluations before and during isolation,
 - c. Conducting reviews by NGOs, which guarantee sealed records in order to assess necessities;
- 7. **Encourages** Member States to facilitate regular communication between inmates and their families, through scheduled visits and monitored digital communication systems, on a monthly basis;
- 8. **Encourages** member states to develop and implement an improvement of rehabilitation and reinsertion programs, while states having the power to choose the approaches of rehabilitation from:
 - a. Providing education and vocational training in prisons by:
 - i. Ensuring access to primary, secondary and higher education programs,
 - ii. Including regular curriculum updates,
 - b. Promoting reinsertion programs to the prisoners through informative talks,
 - c. Offering instructive workshops;
- 9. **Recommends** the establishment of mandatory mental health treatment and psychological monitoring systems in maximum security prisons, ensuring ethical standards and inmate well-being, to be implemented as follows:

- a. Requiring comprehensive psychological evaluations for all inmates upon entry, conducted by certified mental health professionals,
- b. Mandating regular mental health check-ups at least once every 30 days, with increased frequency for high-risk individuals,
- c. Ensuring immediate access to psychiatric care and therapy for inmates diagnosed with mental health conditions,
- d. Providing individualized treatment plans, including counseling, rehabilitation programs, and, where necessary, medical intervention,
- e. Establishing independent oversight by qualified NGOs and international organizations to monitor the quality and ethics of mental health services;

10. **Encourages** Member States to integrate a Benefit-Cost Analysis tool for Supermax Prisons into their national security frameworks by:

- a. assisting officials in evaluating the fiscal and social feasibility of high-security imprisonment,
- b. encourage countries to be transparent with their expenses for the supermax prisons,
- c. the international fund commission, mentioned in Operative Clause 1, may support countries to create the Benefit-Cost Analysis, on request;

11. **Encourages** all states to invest in solitary confinement alternatives and rehabilitation programs that will include:

- a. substance abuse treatments such as Residential Drug Abuse Program (RDAP) in federal prisons and therapeutic communities inside prisons that treat addiction as a medical issue rather than a disciplinary one,
- b. cognitive behavioral therapy represented by structured programs that help incarcerated individuals identify and change destructive thought patterns and behaviors, with treatments such as:
 - i. Moral Reconnection Therapy (MRT), a systematic treatment strategy aimed at enhancing ego, social, moral, and positive behavioral growth,
 - ii. Aggression Replacement Training (ART), a 10-week, multi-session intervention designed for individuals with violent or aggressive

tendencies, consisting of prosocial skills training, anger control training, and moral reasoning,

- iii. Criminal Conduct and Substance Abuse Treatment, a comprehensive, workbook-based program focusing on addressing the cognitive distortions that lead to both substance abuse and criminal behavior,
- iv. Reasoning and Rehabilitation, a cognitive skills program designed to target cognitive deficits such as poor impulse control, egocentrism, and rigid thinking by teaching problem-solving, negotiation, and interpersonal skills;

12. **Encourages** all countries to have a special facility for the placement of mothers with newborn babies, after a verification process for mental and physical capability to be sure they won't harm the children;

13. **Invites** all states to decrease racial disparity, a problem that has existed in places of incarceration for centuries, by implementing in criminal justice systems measures such as:

- a. amending laws that will repeal and revise minimum sentencing laws that disproportionately affect minorities,
- b. decriminalization or reduced penalties for non-violent offenses like drug possession,
- c. improvement of fairness through established national standards to detect, prevent and respond to sexual abuse in detention facilities,
- d. a widely cited international model that mandates rehabilitation as the primary purpose of incarceration, with strong reentry support, reduce high incarceration rates and enhance rehabilitation, data transparency and evidence-based policy;

14. **Designates** incentive based-system for maximum security prisons, consisting in the possibility for prisoners to pass to a lower security level after a period of good behaviour and collaboration with the staff, with the aim to:

- a. reduce overcrowding in maximum security prisons,
- b. lower gang crimes inside prisons,

- c. decrease suicide rates in prisons
 - d. giving the chance to prisoners to increase their condition of living;
- 15. **Calls for** maximum security prisons to let female inmates have access to reproductive care, abortion rights and to essential hygiene products as those are basic needs for their health and mental wellbeing;
- 16. **Proposes** the establishment of a non-governmental institution funded by the United Nations to help the reintegration of the inmates in society after ending their sentence by:
 - a. providing a temporary housing to individuals to help them gain a stable living place,
 - b. guaranteeing a workplace without discrimination of past inmates in order to help them gain a stable income;
- 17. **Suggests** limiting excessive pre-trial detention periods to prevent overcrowding and protect the rights of individuals which are not yet convicted;
- 18. **Encourages** member states to develop and implement comprehensive and ethical education programs for civil servants, including regular curriculum updates and practical training on ethics and accountability;
- 19. **Suggests** that each nation has a minimum number of workplaces reserved for prisoners, as if they are released to be able to have a small income and reintegrate into society;
- 20. **Encourages** states to focus on the security of prisons, especially those in which high risk offenders are incarcerated, assuring a safe environment for their non-guilty citizens by:
 - a. adopting new and digital approaches, such as better suited perimeter controls, identification mechanisms for both prisoners and staff and automatic doors,
 - b. implementing surveillance through sensors and mechanisms that act upon the prisoner or inform staff in case of a tentative escape,

- c. assuring prisons are well equipped in the case of natural disasters or crisis and that these events do not give escape opportunities by:
 - i. building strong walls and a sturdy foundation,
 - ii. assuring the facility is well stocked with food and other necessities,
 - iii. training inmates and teaching them protocols in such cases;

21. **Further proclaims** that the Maximum Security Prison Staff Training Programme is to be structured in the following manner, lasting three weeks and running on UNITAR's virtual learning platform, from which each staff member will be able to choose their own educational course, to be better defined on UNITAR's website, by following:

- a. three learning modules of reading material, multimedia files, a discussion forum and a multiple-choice assessment quiz, divided into the following:
 - i. Module 1 regarding the Overview of the Criminal Justice System, Correctional Rules and Regulations, Maximum Security Prison Code of Conduct;
 - ii. Module 2 including information on Managing Prison Population, Prison Administration and Classification of Inmates;
 - iii. Module 3 teaching on Coping with Stress and Being a Role Model;
- b. a series of 6-hour webinars, in which participants can directly learn from justice officials or other high-level officials, regarding the following syllabus:
 - i. Security Information Reports & the Prison System,
 - ii. Security Precautions for the Safe Delivery of Vocational Training ,
 - iii. Managing High-Risk and Violent Extremist Prisoners,
 - iv. Management of Human & Financial Resources ,
 - v. Detecting Radicalization: Warning and Protective Cues ,
 - vi. Safety, Security, Control, and Discipline ,
- c. three online workshops, delivered by experts, such as former chief wardens previously deployed in rehabilitation programmes and senior high-ranking positions in the prison system, to be attended by participants and debriefed later in group sessions, structured in the following way:

- i. Prevention of Prisoner-to-Prisoner Violence and High-Risk Individual Management,
- ii. Introduction to Digital Infrastructure and Internet Security Awareness,
- iii. Innovative Approaches to Vocational and Rehabilitative Workshops for Prisoners;

22. **Supports** that special cells and help from psychologist should be provided to prisoners that are known to have previous attempts to harm themselves;

23. **Endorses** states to remain actively seized on the matter.